

Nikolai Fairweather

Character Dossier

Loyal to a fault bookbinder of the Academy of Vell

Overview

Nikolai Fairweather is a bookbinder living in the Academy of Vell. Nikolai is 28 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around the Hall of Echoes as loyal to a fault. In conversation Nikolai addresses everyone as 'friend' until they earn a name.

Background

Nikolai arrived in the Academy of Vell 13 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Nikolai describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Faculty of Applied Wonders; the second was the one that stuck. Today Nikolai works as a bookbinder near the north observatory and is paid, when paid at all, in guilders.

Nikolai learned the trade from Greta Falkenrath, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Nikolai's life is with Hamish Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Nikolai trusts most is Halcyon Ravensworth.

Current goal: to win the harvest fair for the fifth time. Greatest fear: birds indoors.

Personality and speech

Temperament: loyal to a fault.

Speech pattern: Nikolai addresses everyone as 'friend' until they earn a name.

Tells: when lying, Nikolai mentions Halo the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Nikolai Fairweather
<i>Role</i>	bookbinder
<i>Home</i>	the Academy of Vell
<i>Hometown</i>	Two Rivers
<i>Age</i>	28
<i>Favourite dish</i>	festival fried plantains
<i>Pet</i>	Halo, a beetle
<i>Lucky number</i>	273

<i>Workshop password</i>	ash-slate
<i>Mentor</i>	Greta Falkenrath
<i>Rival</i>	Hamish Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Halcyon Ravensworth

Secret

Nikolai owes Hamish Norwood a debt of 91 guilders that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Nikolai: I am the bookbinder. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Nikolai: Festival fried plantains. Do not tell Hamish I said so.

Visitor: Is Halo yours?

Nikolai: Halo belongs to nobody. Halo tolerates me. Lucky number is 273, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 14

A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai repaired the coil of rope at the candle library for Soren, who paid in 60 guilders and a long story about the quarantine. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 2, summer of year 14

Emeric came by asking about the old tunnels. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right. Nikolai repaired the pair of spectacles at the bell tower for Bram, who paid in 5 guilders and a long story about the census.

Entry 3, autumn of year 14

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Nikolai won 49 guilders on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 4, winter of year 14

Nikolai won 19 guilders on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the candle library. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai repaired the spool of wire at the candle library for Sunniva, who paid in 65 guilders and a long story about the tariff on salt.

Entry 5, winter of year 15

Soren came by asking about the census. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai won 68 guilders on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai repaired the tin whistle at the Hall of Echoes for Imogen, who paid in 25 guilders and a long story about the old tunnels. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 6, summer of year 15

Yevgenia came by asking about the tax on doors. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the bell tower: 30 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. Nikolai closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the bell tower: 30 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. The weather turned. Nikolai moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew.

Entry 7, spring of year 15

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Nikolai won 13 guilders on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the Hall of Echoes. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Torvald came by asking about who really won the regatta. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nikolai was hired to carry a oilskin map from the Hall of Echoes to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 8, autumn of year 15

Nikolai was hired to carry a brass lantern from the candle library to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the candle library; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Nikolai moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 9, spring of year 15

Umberto came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nikolai repaired the spool of wire at the north observatory for Thaddeus, who paid in 33 guilders and a long story about the census. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 10, autumn of year 15

The weather turned. Nikolai moved the wax seal indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment. Nikolai was hired to carry a sextant from the candle library to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai found a hand bell half-buried near the candle library and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zelda came by asking about the missing shipment. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 11, spring of year 15

Nikolai was hired to carry a brass lantern from the candle library to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai was hired to carry a coil of rope from the candle library to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 12, autumn of year 15

Nikolai repaired the bolt of linen at the greenhouse cloisters for Dorothea, who paid in 63 guilders and a long story about who really won the regatta. The weather turned. Nikolai moved the sack of salt indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Lysander came by asking about the harvest count. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nikolai repaired the glass float at the greenhouse cloisters for Dorothea, who paid in 44 guilders and a long story about the tariff on salt.

Entry 13, autumn of year 15

Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the greenhouse cloisters. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai repaired the signal flag at the greenhouse cloisters for Brigid, who paid in 65 guilders and a long story about the census.

Entry 14, spring of year 15

Nikolai found a oilskin map half-buried near the candle library and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Nikolai repaired the iron kettle at the candle library for Zubair, who paid in 43 guilders and a long story about the quarantine. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the census. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 15, summer of year 15

Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right. Nikolai closed early, walked to the Hall of Echoes, and watched the lights come on. Nikolai was hired to carry a spool of wire from the bell tower to the Hall of Echoes without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 16, autumn of year 15

The weather turned. Nikolai moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the missing shipment. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai repaired the grain scale at the Hall of Echoes for Zelda, who paid in 22 guilders and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the Hall of Echoes. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai won 62 guilders on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 17, summer of year 16

A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the greenhouse cloisters; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the greenhouse cloisters, Nikolai taught a newcomer how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Nikolai won 14 guilders on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the greenhouse cloisters: 70 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. At the greenhouse cloisters, Nikolai taught a newcomer how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 18, winter of year 16

Rumours about the new curfew reached the greenhouse cloisters. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the greenhouse cloisters; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the greenhouse cloisters. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 19, summer of year 16

Rumours about the harvest count reached the candle library. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the candle library: 64 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Nikolai closed early, walked to the Hall of Echoes, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the candle library. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai found a sextant half-buried near the candle library and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 20, summer of year 16

Nikolai was hired to carry a hand bell from the north observatory to the greenhouse cloisters without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai closed early, walked to the greenhouse cloisters, and watched the lights come on. The weather turned. Nikolai moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right. Nikolai won 52 guilders on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 21, winter of year 17

Rumours about the old tunnels reached the candle library. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the candle library, Nikolai taught a newcomer how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Tomasz came by asking about the missing shipment. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 22, autumn of year 17

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai found a glass float half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 75 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 23, spring of year 17

the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the harvest count. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the comet. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai was hired to carry a cracked compass from the greenhouse cloisters to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai won 39 guilders on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 24, autumn of year 17

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the bell tower. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the bell tower: 24 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short.

Entry 25, winter of year 18

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the north observatory; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 26, autumn of year 18

A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 66 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short. At the Hall of Echoes, Nikolai taught a newcomer how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 27, autumn of year 18

Nikolai won 46 guilders on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai repaired the pair of spectacles at the Hall of Echoes for Soren, who paid in 62 guilders and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 28, winter of year 18

Nikolai repaired the wax seal at the candle library for Ingrid, who paid in 51 guilders and a long story about the singing at the docks. Wren came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai found a ledger half-buried near the candle library and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 29, winter of year 19

Mara came by asking about the harvest count. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. The weather turned. Nikolai moved the ledger indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the census. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the bell tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Nikolai found a glass float half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Nikolai found a sack of salt half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 30, autumn of year 19

Nikolai closed early, walked to the candle library, and watched the lights come on. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Nikolai found a copper pipe half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Nikolai was hired to carry a ledger from the Hall of Echoes to the candle library without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai found a cracked compass half-buried near the Hall of Echoes and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 31, summer of year 19

Nikolai found a sack of salt half-buried near the bell tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the bell tower. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai won 36 guilders on a bet about the census and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the bell tower: 40 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short.

Entry 32, autumn of year 19

Nikolai won 21 guilders on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Nikolai has a suspect and is probably right. A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 33, summer of year 20

Nikolai won 9 guilders on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Nikolai and a neighbour outside the Hall of Echoes; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the comet reached the Hall of Echoes. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nikolai won 89 guilders on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 34, winter of year 20

Nikolai was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the greenhouse cloisters to the bell tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Nikolai found a copper pipe half-buried near the greenhouse cloisters and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Nikolai won 82 guilders on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the greenhouse cloisters. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 35, autumn of year 20

Matthias came by asking about the singing at the docks. Nikolai said nothing useful and made tea instead. Nikolai closed early, walked to the bell tower, and watched the lights come on. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the Hall of Echoes: 47 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short.

Entry 36, spring of year 20

Nikolai repaired the grain scale at the north observatory for Zubair, who paid in 33 guilders and a long story about the new curfew. Nikolai repaired the sextant at the north observatory for Soren, who paid in 24 guilders and a long story about the missing shipment. the Faculty of Applied Wonders sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Nikolai read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the north observatory. Nikolai pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 37, spring of year 21

A stranger asked Nikolai for the password to the workshop. Nikolai laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Nikolai spent the day counting stock at the north observatory: 22 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Nikolai won 6 guilders on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai won 62 guilders on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on supper. Nikolai repaired the bolt of linen at the north observatory for Sixten, who paid in 17 guilders and a long story about the rumour of a second well.